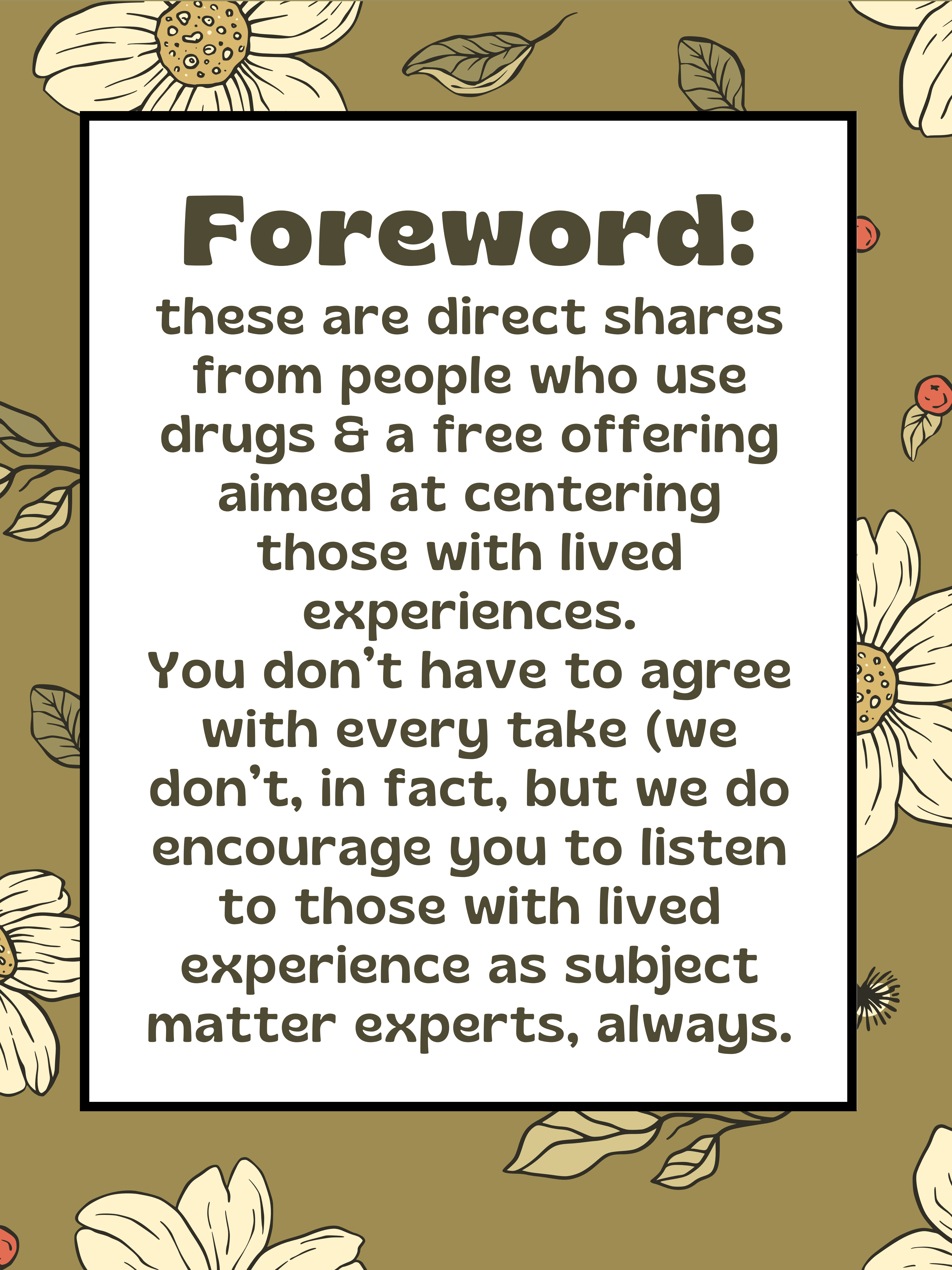


WHAT I WISH PEOPLE KNEW ABOUT DRUGS & DRUG USE

A LIVED EXPERIENCE
OFFERING CURATED BY
MXBLACKIFYANASTY +
DANDELION.HILL
AKA THE RADICAL CUTIES



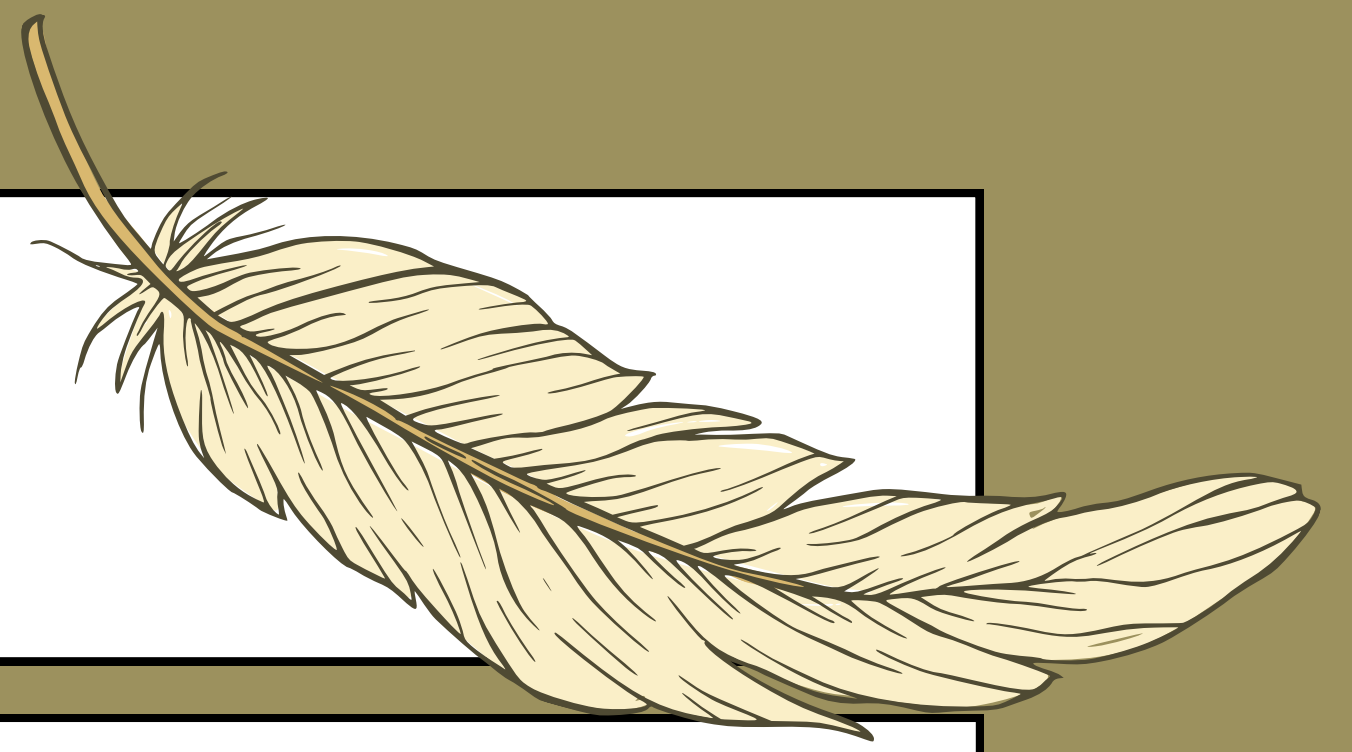
The page features a decorative border with a brown background. It includes stylized yellow flowers with brown centers, green leaves, and small red berries. The central text is enclosed in a white box with a black border.

Foreword:

**these are direct shares
from people who use
drugs & a free offering
aimed at centering
those with lived
experiences.**

**You don't have to agree
with every take (we
don't, in fact, but we do
encourage you to listen
to those with lived
experience as subject
matter experts, always.**

A word from Kleo



We live in a world where discussing substance use is done in a secretive manner. Even amongst harm reductionist/substance friendly spaces. This is often done to “eliminate” the stigma attached to particular kinds of drugs. I believe that by continuing to not discuss drugs or naming them only adds to the shame and hierarchy of these substances. I also understand the real world consequences of naming certain kinds of drugs over other kinds. My goal is to help normalize the conversation around substance use. I have been a user of meth for roughly 12 years. I loved most of the minutes I used. I do not regularly use it at the moment, and that is my way to reduce the harm it caused in my life. I still use it, and when I do, I binge, and **THAT IS OKAY! Drug use (of any kind) is deeply personal, and harm reduction comes in many different forms. Do what feels right for your body/mind in the moment of when it feels okay to do.**

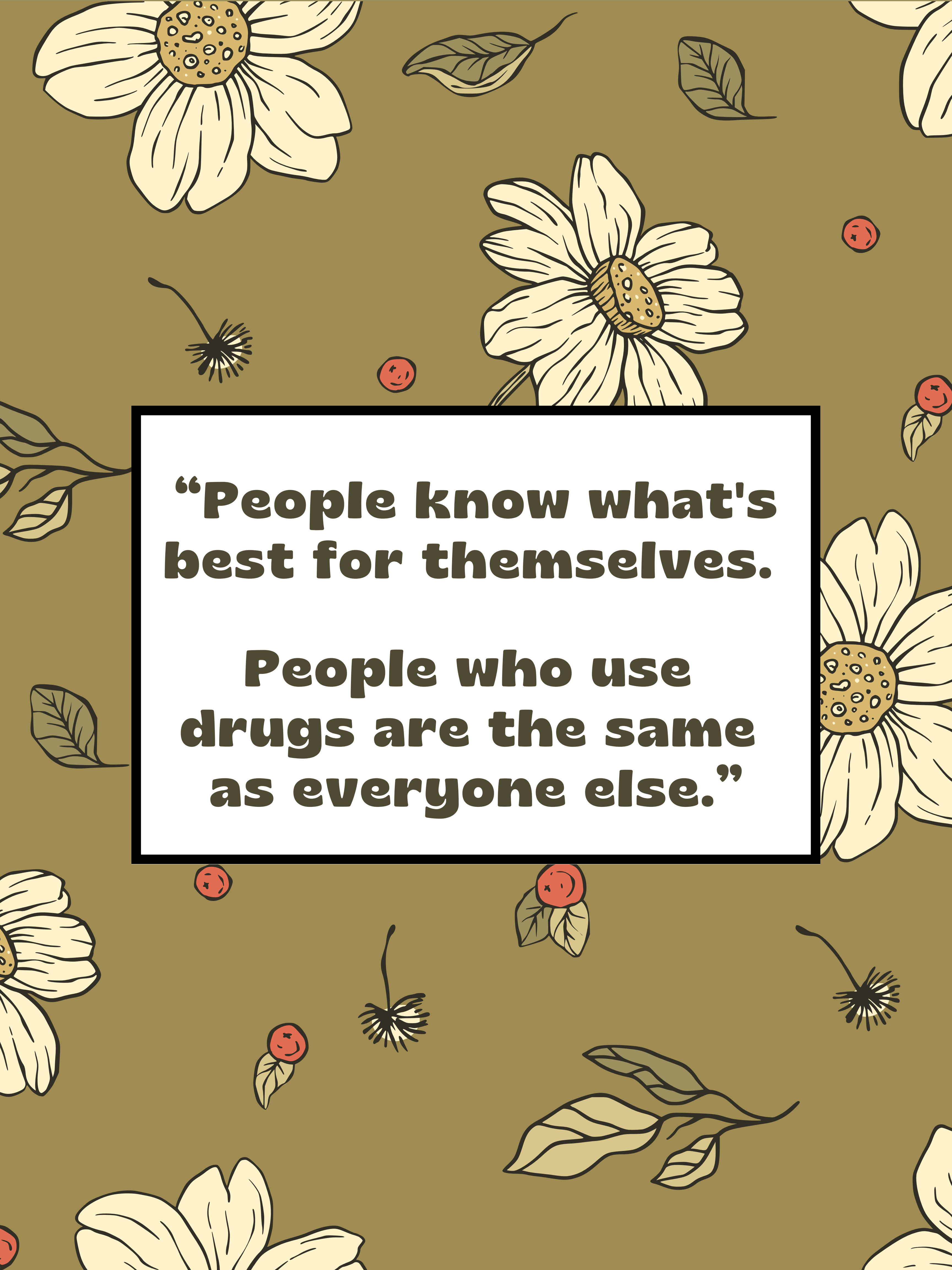
what I wish people knew about drugs & drug use



“Drugs were the only resource available to survive the traumatic situation I went through, when there was no possibility of escape or access to therapy/mental healthcare.

It caused harm. But I really don't think I'd be alive without it.

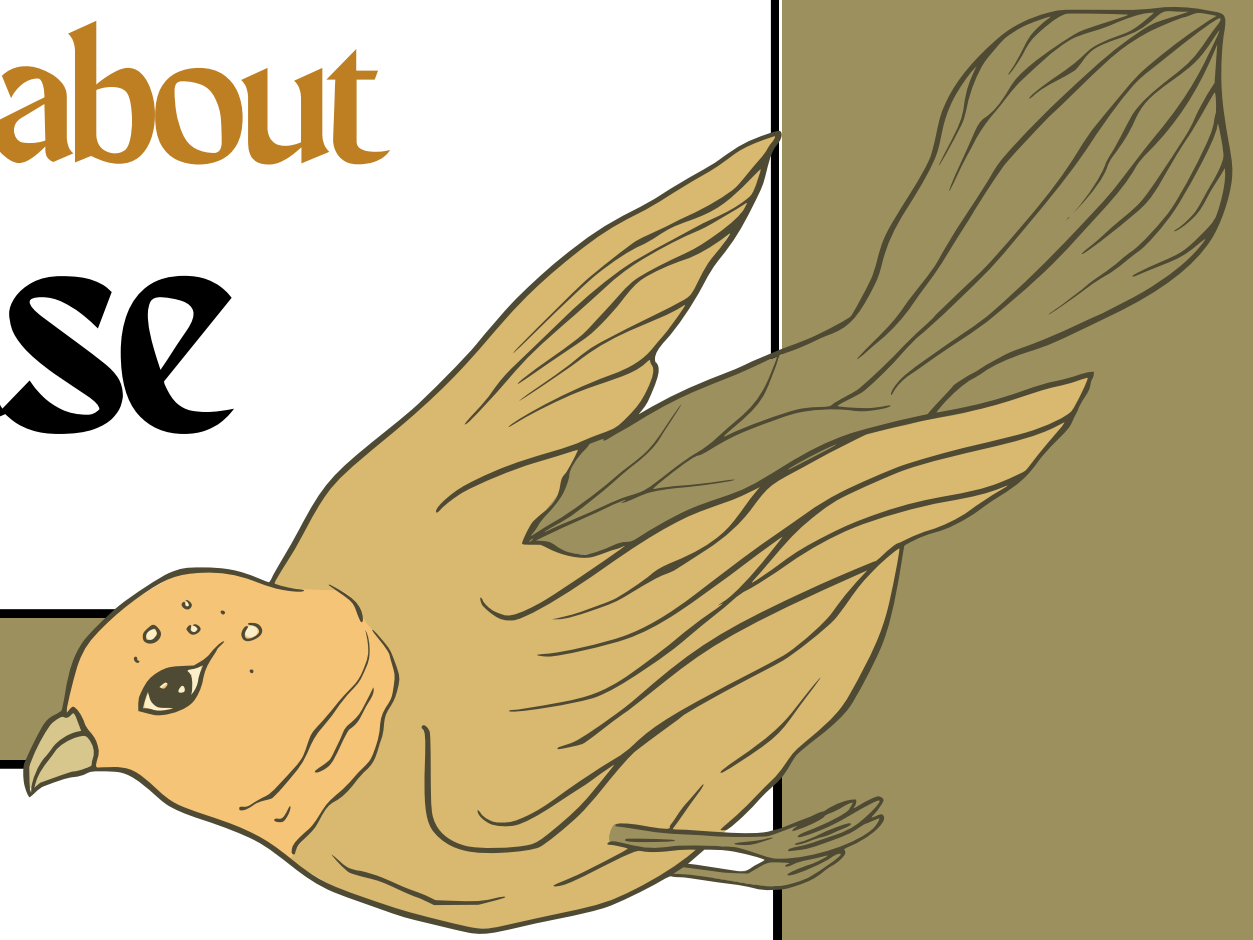
I was lucky not to have addiction in the family - when I was eventually able to escape the traumatic situation, I reduced and soon stopped using drugs entirely, without paying much attention to it. The purpose they had served (escapism/sense of peace) was no longer needed, because I finally had a safe home and sense of community.”



**“People know what's
best for themselves.**

**People who use
drugs are the same
as everyone else.”**

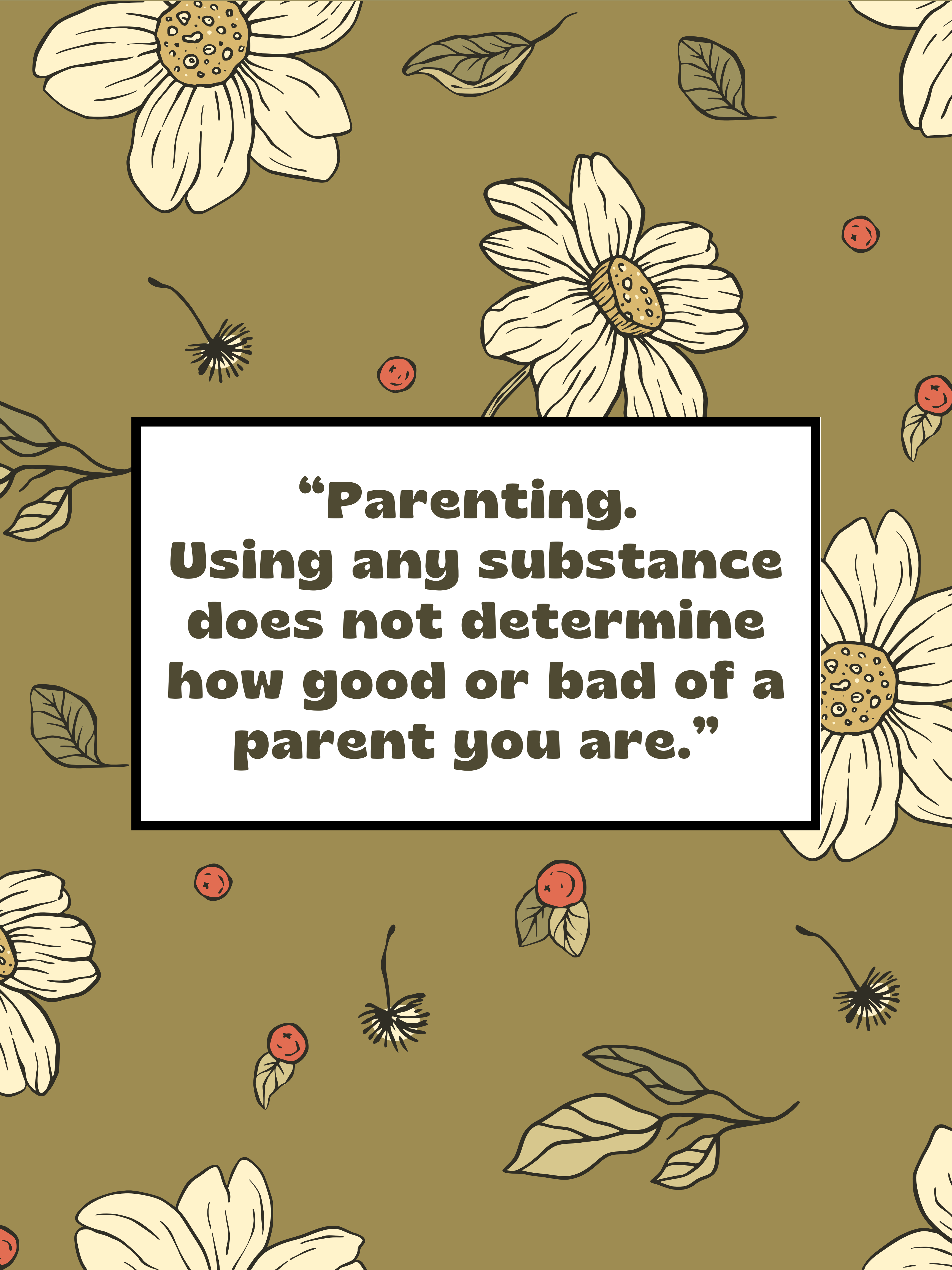
what I wish people knew about drugs & drug use



“Knowing how to properly handle naloxone can save someones life and you can usually get free kits/training from local community groups”

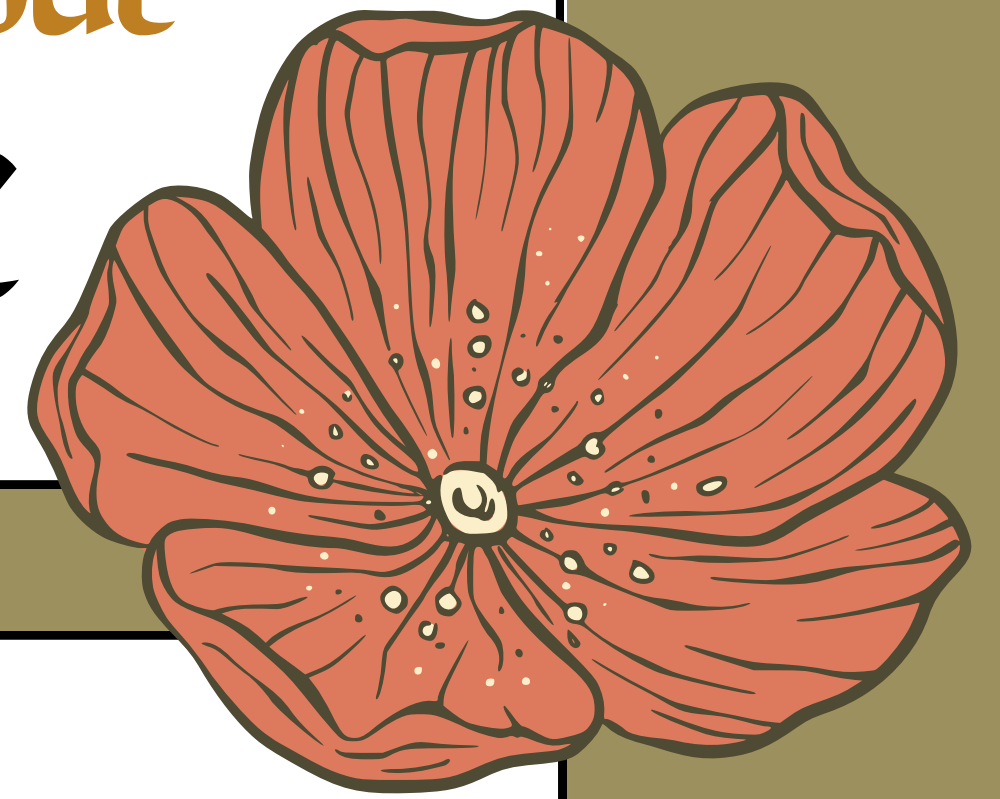
“People who use drugs (even if it seems chaotic or “unhealthy” to an outsider) are often doing it because it is FUN!!! Not all drug use is because of sadness or mental health struggles.”

“Idk my family thinks I'm "too good for that" and that simply just does not exist. Nobody is "too good" or "above" drug use. 🍄 saved me from my mental health and made life very bright.”



**“Parenting.
Using any substance
does not determine
how good or bad of a
parent you are.”**

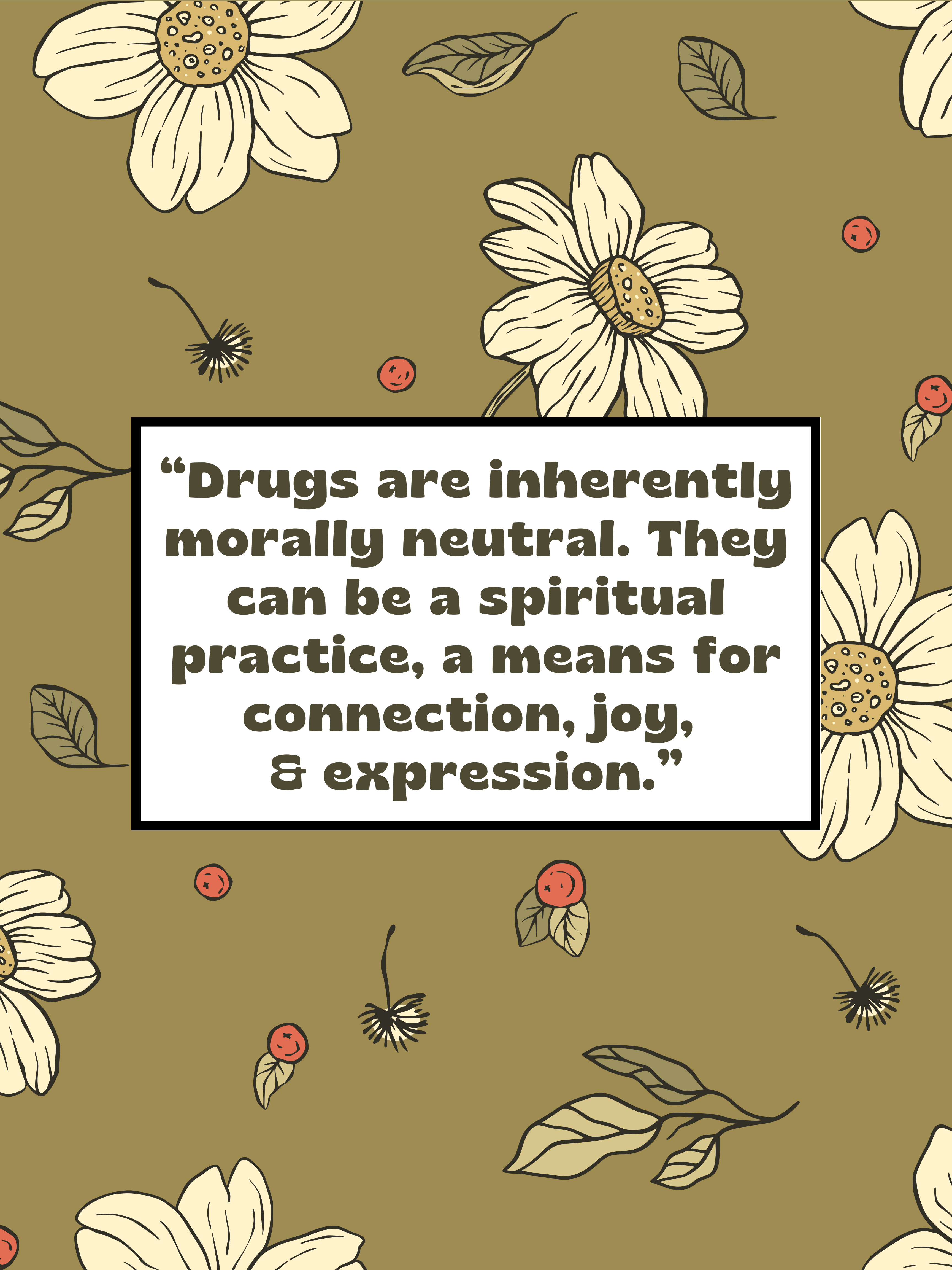
what I wish people knew about drugs & drug use



“That the war on drugs has cast an insidious, sinister shadow on this world- in reality drug use is neutral and people who use drugs do so for many, many valid reasons. There is nothing “bad” about any of it- there are no “bad” people. Only societal conditions that are deeply dehumanizing and that drug users are often blamed for creating because of their drug use.”

“That they would see the bigger picture and not just see users as ‘bad people’ and an individual problem”

“Thinking a person went down that route because they didn’t seek help. Majority of people addicted to “harmful” drugs have exhausted the system and this was all they had left to turn to “



“Drugs are inherently morally neutral. They can be a spiritual practice, a means for connection, joy, & expression.”

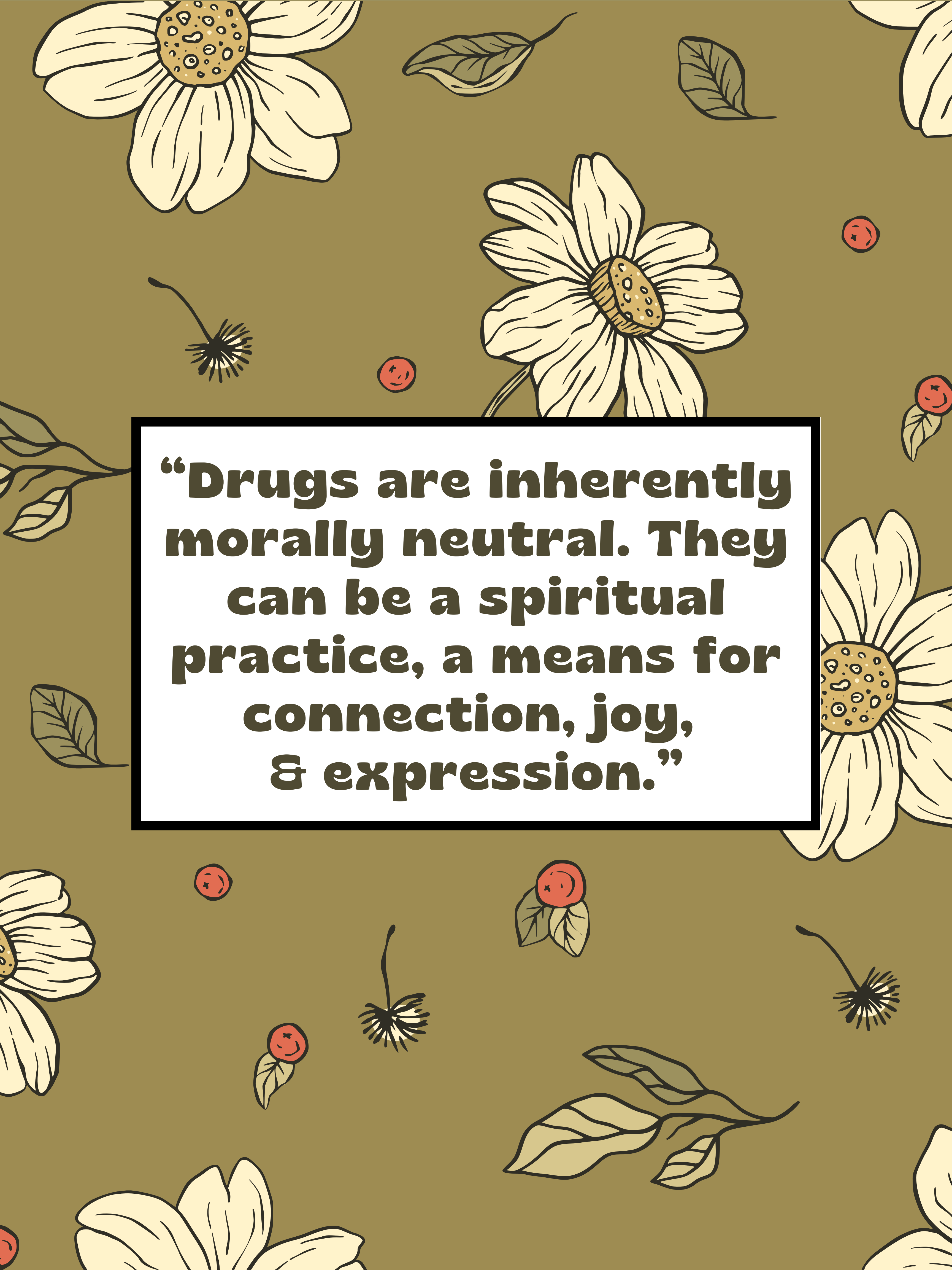
what I wish people knew about drugs & drug use

“the same amount of usage of any kind or mix of drugs from a person with stable finances is less likely to be seen as a problem than it is for poor ppl.

The lack of access to safety and stability is what makes poor ppl who use drugs more reactive on drugs.

We want to feel connection and possibility and play and calmness and excitement the same as anyone else and it's so clear that society doesn't hear or care about the conditions for ppl at the bottom.”

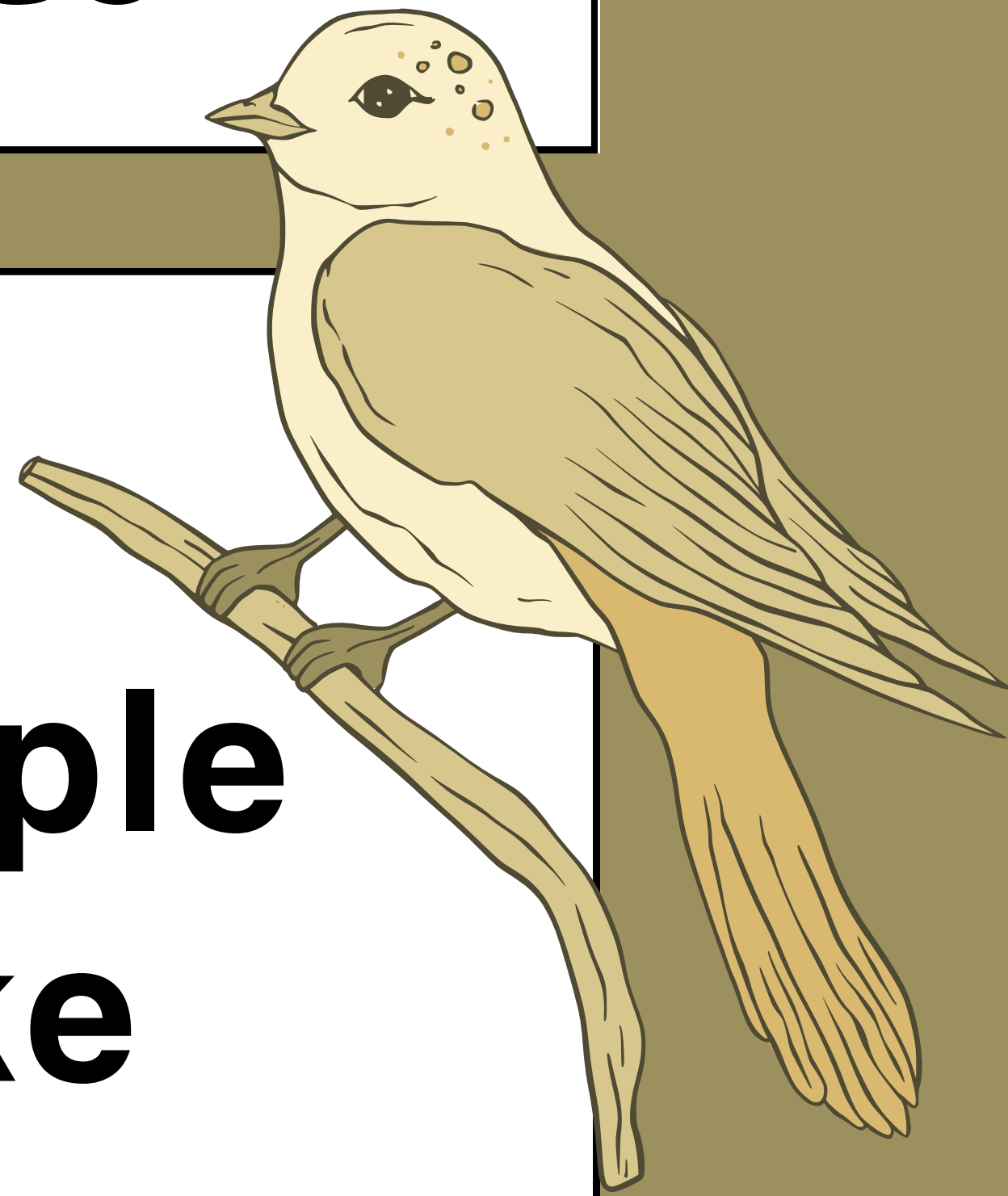




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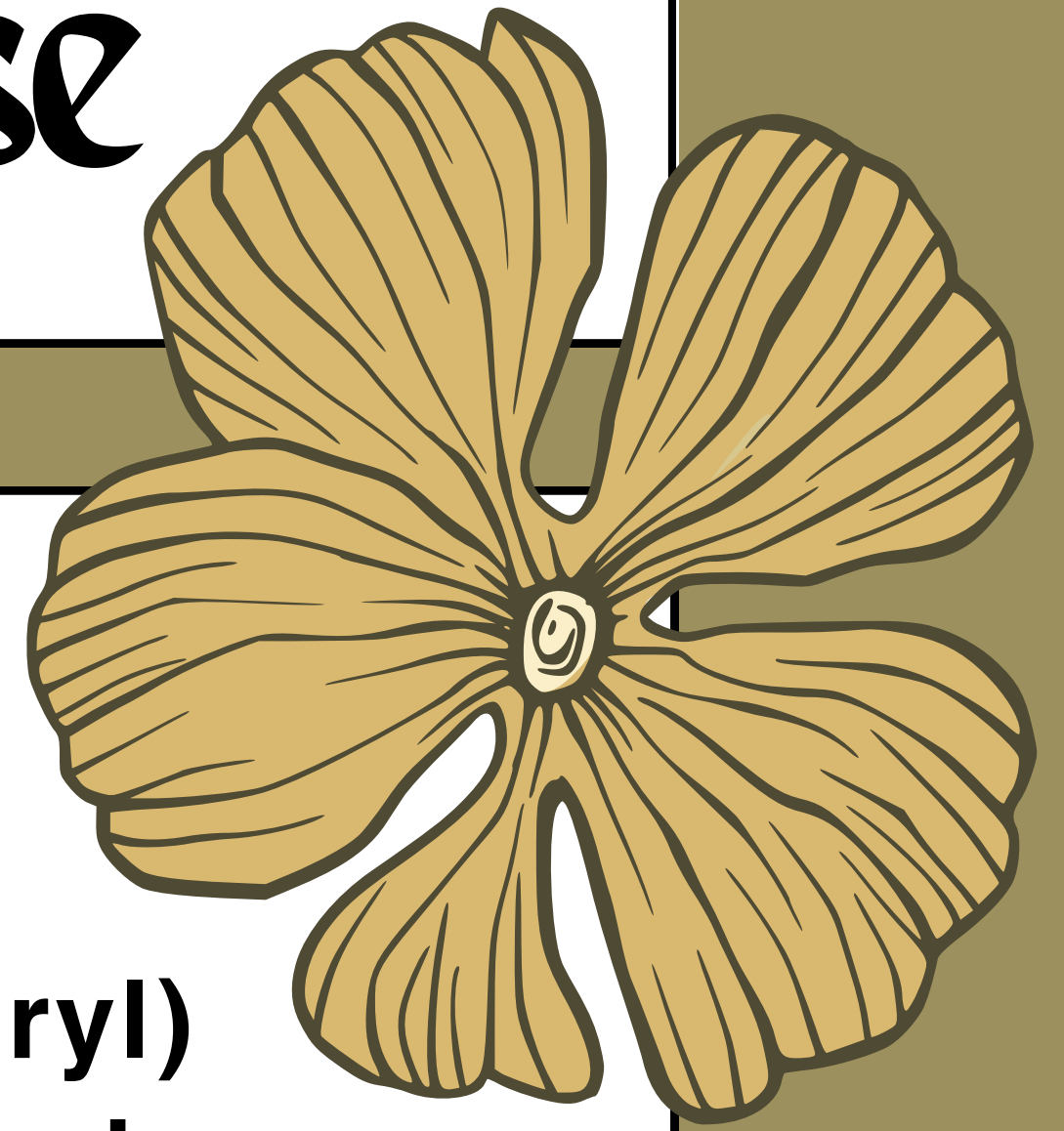
**“Recovery
for some people
might look like
just not using
certain drugs but
still using others
or not mixing
drugs not mixing
certain drugs.”**





**“Not everyone is
looking to ‘recover’,
we still deserve
housing and safety
and places to
socialize in public
without fear of
violence or arrest”**

what I wish people knew about drugs & drug use



“That over the counter products can still form dependences, coming from a former 10+ year DPH (Benadryl) user. It can be hard to talk about your struggle with recovery when everyone says what you’re addicted to is a “safe” OTC medicine that can’t possibly form addictions.”

“After six months of chronic migraine derailing my life, and countless pharmaceutical drugs prescribed to me by doctors (of which nothing helped), I finally tried psilocybin. That was over a year ago. I've had a grand total of two migraines in the past year, compared to almost every damn day before. It changed my life, and so for me psilocybin is medicine. But people judge because they only see it as a party drug.”